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Web-based content presentation via smart television device application

Abstract

Disclosed herein are system, method and/or computer program product embodiments, and/or combinations and sub-combinations thereof, for presenting web-based content to a display by an application installed on a smart television (TV) device. An example embodiment includes a web-based content collection and transformation service that is configured to access web-based content via a world wide web, create a copy of the web-based content, transform the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to the display by the application, and store the transformed copy of the web-based content to a data storage system that is accessible to the application. In further accordance with this example embodiment, the application is configured to obtain the transformed copy of the web-based content from the data storage system and present it to the display.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

Field

(1) This disclosure is generally directed to techniques for presenting content to a display and, in particular, to techniques for presenting web-based content to a display.

SUMMARY

(2) Provided herein are system, apparatus, article of manufacture, method and/or computer program product embodiments, and/or combinations and sub-combinations thereof, for presenting web-based content to a display by an application installed on a smart television (TV) device. An example embodiment includes a web-based content collection and transformation service that is configured to access web-based content via a world wide web (“web”), create a copy of the web-based content, transform the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to the display by the application, and store the transformed copy of the web-based content to a data storage system that is accessible to the application. In further accordance with such an embodiment, the application is configured to obtain the transformed copy of the web-based content from the data storage system and present the transformed copy of the web-based content to the display.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(1) The accompanying drawings are incorporated herein and form a part of the specification.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram of a multimedia environment, according to some embodiments.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram of a streaming media device, according to some embodiments.

- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates a block diagram of a web-based content collection and transformation service, according to some embodiments.
- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates a block diagram of a web-based content presentation application, according to some embodiments.
- (6) FIG. 5 illustrates a flow diagram of a method for collecting web-based content and transforming and storing the same so that it may be presented to a display by an application installed on a smart television device, according to some embodiments.
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates a flow diagram of a method performed by an application installed on a smart television device for obtaining a transformed copy of web-based content and presenting the same to a display, according to some embodiments.
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates an example computer system useful for implementing various embodiments.
- (9) In the drawings, like reference numbers generally indicate identical or similar elements. Additionally, generally, the left-most digit(s) of a reference number identifies the drawing in which the reference number first appears.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) For a variety of reasons, a user may wish to display content accessed via the world wide web (e.g., a webpage, or text, image, video and/or audio content included within a webpage) on a relatively large screen as opposed to the relatively small screens typically associated with smart phones, laptop computers, tablet computers, and desktop computers. For example, in an enterprise, it may be deemed useful to display web-based content that is relevant to employees on a number of large screens distributed across one or more offices, thereby enabling the employees to easily view such web-based content. Likewise, in a retail store or restaurant, it may be deemed desirable to display web-based content to customers or patrons via a number of large screens distributed throughout a shopping or dining space. One approach to achieving this would be to physically connect a separate computer running a web browser to each such display and then navigate each such web browser to the desired content. However, this approach is both expensive and logistically complex.

(11) Owing to significant advances in display technology and manufacturing, it is now possible for consumers to obtain large flat screen televisions (TVs) with display sizes ranging from 55 to 85 inches at a relatively low cost, with even larger display sizes available. Such large displays could potentially provide a more convenient and desirable way to view web-based content in the home as compared to the aforementioned relatively small screens typically associated with smart phones, laptop computers, tablet computers, and desktop computers. Also, such large displays could potentially provide a means for communal viewing of web-based content by a group of family members and/or friends in a home. One approach to achieving this would be to connect a computer with a web browser installed thereon to a TV and then operate the computer to navigate the web browser to the desired web-content. However, this approach is far from user-friendly, as it requires a user to physically connect the computer to an input port of the TV (assuming such an input port is even available), switch the TV to the relevant input port, and then navigate the web browser on the computer to the desired web content.

(12) Provided herein are system, apparatus, device, method and/or computer program product embodiments, and/or combinations and sub-combinations thereof, for presenting web-based content to a display by an application installed on a smart TV device that addresses one or more of the foregoing issues. For example, as will be described herein, an application installed on a smart TV device (e.g., a smart TV or a device that connects to a TV to provide smart TV features thereto) may be used to present web-based content to a display. In particular, a web-based content collection and transformation service may operate to access the web-based content via a world wide web, create a copy of the web-based content, transform the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to the display by the application, and store the transformed copy of the web-based content to a data storage system that is accessible to the application. The application

may be configured to obtain the transformed copy of the web-based content from the data storage system and present the transformed copy of the web-based content to the display.

(13) In accordance with the disclosed techniques for presenting web-based content via a smart TV device application, web-based content that would normally be accessed and viewed via the relatively small displays typically associated with smart phones, laptop computers, tablet computers, and desktop computers, can instead be viewed via the relatively large displays associated with some TVs, such as some flat screen TVs.

(14) In further accordance with the disclosed techniques for presenting web-based content via a smart TV device application, the application for presenting the web-based content may be easily installed and executed on any number of smart TV devices, thereby enabling web-based content to be presented to any number of displays associated with any number of TVs, without having to connect a separate browser-enabled computer to each TV.

(15) In still further accordance with the disclosed techniques for presenting web-based content via a smart TV device application, the aforementioned service automatically navigates the web to collect the web-based content, transforms the web-based content into a form suitable for display, and stores the transformed web-based content in the aforementioned data storage system, where it may be accessed by any number of applications executing on any number of smart TV devices. Because the service performs the web navigation operations to obtain the web-based content and the transformation operations to render it into a form suitable for display, the applications themselves need not perform such operations. This can enable the applications to be more lightweight or streamlined, thus consuming fewer resources (e.g., processor cycles, memory) of the smart TV devices upon which they are installed.

(16) In yet further accordance with the disclosed techniques for presenting web-based content via a smart TV device application, the web-based content that is presented to the display may be automatically collected by the aforementioned service and transformed into a form suitable for presentation to the display by the application. This can entail, for example, transforming the web-based content into a form that can be viewed or otherwise consumed using a remote control associated with the smart TV device, which may provide a far simpler control scheme as compared to a conventional computer and web browser. Thus, a user may be enabled to consume web-based content using such far simpler control scheme.

(17) Various embodiments of this disclosure may be implemented using and/or may be part of a multimedia environment **102** shown in FIG. **1**. It is noted, however, that multimedia environment **102** is provided solely for illustrative purposes, and is not limiting. Embodiments of this disclosure may be implemented using and/or may be part of environments different from and/or in addition to the multimedia environment **102**, as will be appreciated by persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the teachings contained herein. An example of the multimedia environment **102** shall now be described.

(18) Multimedia Environment

(19) FIG. **1** illustrates a block diagram of a multimedia environment **102**, according to some embodiments. In a non-limiting example, multimedia environment **102** may be directed to streaming media. However, this disclosure is applicable to any type of media (instead of or in addition to streaming media), as well as any mechanism, means, protocol, method and/or process for distributing media.

(20) Multimedia environment **102** may include one or more media systems **104**. A media system **104** could represent a family room, a kitchen, a backyard, a home theater, a school classroom, a library, a car, a boat, a bus, a plane, a movie theater, a stadium, an auditorium, a park, a bar, a restaurant, or any other location or space where it is desired to receive and play streaming content. User(s) **132** may operate with the media system **104** to select and consume content.

(21) Each media system **104** may include one or more media devices **106** each coupled to one or more display devices **108**. It is noted that terms such as “coupled,” “connected to,” “attached,”

“linked,” “combined” and similar terms may refer to physical, electrical, magnetic, logical, etc., connections, unless otherwise specified herein.

(22) Media device **106** may be a streaming media device, DVD or BLU-RAY device, audio/video playback device, cable box, and/or digital video recording device, to name just a few examples. Media device **106** may comprise a smart TV device. As used herein, the term “smart TV device” is intended to encompass TVs with integrated processing and digital communication capabilities, as well as devices (e.g., streaming media devices or set-top boxes) that connect to TVs and provide smart TV functionality thereto. As will be discussed herein, such smart TV functionality may include, for example, and without limitation, the ability to execute applications that obtain content via the Internet and present such content to a display, such as display device **108**.

(23) Display device **108** may be a monitor, television (TV), computer, smart phone, tablet, wearable (such as a watch or glasses), appliance, internet of things (IoT) device, and/or projector, to name just a few examples. In some embodiments, media device **106** can be a part of, integrated with, operatively coupled to, and/or connected to its respective display device **108**.

(24) Each media device **106** may be configured to communicate with network **118** via a communication device **114**. Communication device **114** may include, for example, a cable modem or satellite TV transceiver. Media device **106** may communicate with communication device **114** over a link **116**, wherein link **116** may include wireless (such as Wi-Fi) and/or wired connections.

(25) In various embodiments, network **118** can include, without limitation, wired and/or wireless intranet, extranet, Internet, cellular, Bluetooth, infrared, and/or any other short range, long range, local, regional, global communications mechanism, means, approach, protocol and/or network, as well as any combination(s) thereof.

(26) Media system **104** may include a remote control **110**. Remote control **110** can be any component, part, apparatus and/or method for controlling media device **106** and/or display device **108**, such as a remote control, a tablet, laptop computer, smartphone, wearable, on-screen controls, integrated control buttons, audio controls, or any combination thereof, to name just a few examples. In an embodiment, remote control **110** wirelessly communicates with media device **106** and/or display device **108** using cellular, Bluetooth, infrared, etc., or any combination thereof. Remote control **110** may include a microphone **112**, which is further described below.

(27) Multimedia environment **102** may include a plurality of content servers **120** (also called content providers, channels or sources **120**). Although only one content server **120** is shown in FIG. **1**, in practice multimedia environment **102** may include any number of content servers **120**. Each content server **120** may be configured to communicate with network **118**.

(28) Each content server **120** may store content **122** and metadata **124**. Content **122** may include any combination of music, videos, movies, TV programs, multimedia, images, still pictures, text, graphics, gaming applications, advertisements, programming content, public service content, government content, local community content, software, and/or any other content or data objects in electronic form.

(29) In some embodiments, metadata **124** comprises data about content **122**. For example, metadata **124** may include associated or ancillary information indicating or related to writer, director, producer, composer, artist, actor, summary, chapters, production, history, year, trailers, alternate versions, related content, applications, and/or any other information pertaining or relating to content **122**. Metadata **124** may also or alternatively include links to any such information pertaining or relating to content **122**. Metadata **124** may also or alternatively include one or more indexes of content **122**.

(30) Multimedia environment **102** may include one or more system servers **126**. System servers **126** may operate to support media devices **106** from the cloud. It is noted that the structural and functional aspects of system servers **126** may wholly or partially exist in the same or different ones of system servers **126**.

(31) System servers **126** may include an application distribution service **128**. Application

distribution service **128** may enable user **132** to browse a plurality of smart TV device applications and select certain smart TV device applications from among the plurality of smart TV device applications for installation to media device **106**. For example, media device **106** may present a user interface (UI), such as a graphical UI (GUI), associated with application distribution service **128** to display device **108**. A user may interact with the UI (e.g., by using remote control **110**) to browse a plurality of smart TV device applications and to select one of the plurality of smart TV device applications for installation on media device **106**. In response to such selection, application distribution service **128** may cause the selected smart TV device application to be downloaded and installed on media device **106**. As will be discussed below in reference to FIG. 2, such smart TV device applications may include a web-based content presentation application **210** that may be installed on media device **106** and subsequently executed to present certain web-based content to display device **108**.

(32) System servers **126** may also include a web-based content collection and transformation service **130**. Web-based content collection and transformation service **130** may operate to access web-based content via the world wide web (e.g., via network **118**), create a copy of the web-based content, and transform the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to a display (e.g., display device **108**) by the aforementioned web-based content presentation application **210**, thereby generating a transformed copy of web-based content **136**. Web-based content collection and transformation service **130** may further operate to store transformed copy of web-based content **136** to a data storage system **134** that is communicatively connected to network **118** and that is accessible to application **210** installed on media device **106** via network **118**.

(33) System servers **126** may also include an audio command processing module **138**. As noted above, remote control **110** may include microphone **112**. Microphone **112** may receive audio data from users **132** (as well as other sources, such as the display device **108**). In some embodiments, media device **106** may be audio responsive, and the audio data may represent verbal commands from user **132** to control media device **106** as well as other components in media system **104**, such as display device **108**.

(34) In some embodiments, the audio data received by microphone **112** in remote control **110** is transferred to media device **106**, which then forwards the audio data to audio command processing module **138** in system servers **126**. Audio command processing module **138** may operate to process and analyze the received audio data to recognize a verbal command of user **132**. Audio command processing module **138** may then forward the verbal command back to media device **106** for processing.

(35) In some embodiments, the audio data may be alternatively or additionally processed and analyzed by an audio command processing module **216** in media device **106** (see FIG. 2). Media device **106** and system servers **126** may then cooperate to pick one of the verbal commands to process (either the verbal command recognized by audio command processing module **138** in system servers **126**, or the verbal command recognized by audio command processing module **216** in media device **106**).

(36) Multimedia environment **102** may include a data storage system **134**. Data storage system **134** may store transformed copy of web-based content **136** generated by web-based content collection and transformation service **130**, so that such transformed copy of web-based content **136** can be obtained therefrom by various instances of web-based content presentation application **210** installed respectively on various media devices, such as media device **106**. Data storage system **134** may comprise, for example, a cloud-based data storage system. However, this is only one non-limiting example and data storage system **134** may be implemented by one or more computing devices (e.g., servers) using any suitable data storage technology, including but not limited to direct attached storage (DAS) or network-based storage. Furthermore, data storage system **134** may be implemented using any suitable data storage devices, including but not limited to hard disk drives (HDDs), solid state drives (SSDs), flash drives, tape drives, or the like. In certain implementation,

data storage system **134** may comprise part of content server(s) **120**, in which case data storage system **134** may also store content **122** and/or metadata **124**.

(37) FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram of an example media device **106**, according to some embodiments. Media device **106** may include a streaming module **202**, a processing module **204**, storage/buffers **208**, a user interface module **206**, and a streaming media context classification module **218**. As described above, user interface module **206** may include audio command processing module **216**.

(38) Media device **106** may also include one or more audio decoders **212** and one or more video decoders **214**.

(39) Each audio decoder **212** may be configured to decode audio of one or more audio formats, such as but not limited to AAC, HE-AAC, AC3 (Dolby Digital), EAC3 (Dolby Digital Plus), WMA, WAV, PCM, MP3, OGG GSM, FLAC, AU, AIFF, and/or VOX, to name just some examples.

(40) Similarly, each video decoder **214** may be configured to decode video of one or more video formats, such as but not limited to MP4 (mp4, m4a, m4v, f4v, f4a, m4b, m4r, f4b, mov), 3GP (3gp, 3gp2, 3g2, 3gpp, 3gpp2), OGG (ogg, oga, ogv, ogx), WMV (wmv, wma, asf), WEBM, FLV, AVI, QuickTime, HDV, MXF (OP1a, OP-Atom), MPEG-TS, MPEG-2 PS, MPEG-2 TS, WAV, Broadcast WAV, LXF, GXF, and/or VOB, to name just some examples. Each video decoder **214** may include one or more video codecs, such as but not limited to H.263, H.264, H.265, AVI, HEV, MPEG1, MPEG2, MPEG-TS, MPEG-4, Theora, 3GP, DV, DVCPRO, DVCProHD, IMX, XDCAM HD, XDCAM HD422, and/or XDCAM EX, to name just some examples.

(41) Now referring to both FIGS. 1 and 2, in some embodiments, user **132** may interact with media device **106** via, for example, remote control **110**. For example, user **132** may use remote control **110** to interact with user interface module **206** of media device **106** to select a content item, such as a movie, TV show, music, book, application, game, etc. In response to the user selection, streaming module **202** of media device **106** may request the selected content item from content server(s) **120** over network **118**. Content server(s) **120** may transmit the requested content item to streaming module **202**. Media device **106** may transmit the received content item to display device **108** for playback to user **132**.

(42) In streaming embodiments, streaming module **202** may transmit the content item to display device **108** in real time or near real time as it receives such content item from content server(s) **120**. In non-streaming embodiments, media device **106** may store the content item received from content server(s) **120** in storage/buffers **208** for later playback on display device **108**.

(43) In further embodiments, user **132** may interact with user interface module **206** of media device **106** (e.g., using remote control **110**) to select web-based content presentation application **210** from among a plurality of smart TV device applications made available by application distribution service **128**. In response to such selection, application distribution service **128** may cause application **210** to be downloaded to and installed on media device **106**. For example, application **210** may be installed to storage/buffers **208** of media device **106**, as shown in FIG. 2. Once application **210** has been installed to media device **106**, user **132** may interact with user interface module **206** of media device **106** (e.g., using remote control **110**) to cause application **210** to be executed by processing module **204**. During execution, web-based content presentation application **210** may operate to obtain transformed copy of web-based content **136** from data storage system **134** and present it to display device **108** so that user **132** may view it.

(44) In alternative implementations, application **210** may be pre-installed on media device **106** at a time of manufacture of media device **106** and thus need not be installed thereon by user **132**.

(45) Web-Based Content Presentation Via Smart Television Device Application

(46) Referring again to FIGS. 1 and 2, web-based content collection and transformation service **130** may operate to access web-based content via the world wide web (e.g., via network **118**), create a copy of the web-based content, transform the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable

for presentation to a display (e.g., display device **108**) by web-based content presentation application **210**, thereby generating transformed copy of web-based content **136**, and store transformed copy of web-based content **136** to data storage system **134** that is accessible to application **210**. Application **210** installed on media device **106** may operate to obtain transformed copy of web-based content **136** from data storage system **134** and present it to a display (e.g., display device **108**).

(47) FIG. 3 illustrates a block diagram of an example implementation of web-based content collection and transformation service **130**, according to some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 3, web-based content collection and transformation service **130** may comprise a web-based content collector **302**, a web-based content transformer **304**, and a transformed web-based content provider **306**. Each of these components may be implemented by processing logic that can comprise hardware (e.g., circuitry, dedicated logic, programmable logic, microcode, etc.), software (e.g., instructions executing on a processing device), or a combination thereof. Each of these components will now be described.

(48) Web-based content collector **302** may be configured to access web-based content via the world wide web (e.g., via network **118**), create a copy of the web-based content, and provide the copy of the web-based content to web-based content transformer **304**. The web-based content may comprise any type of content that can be accessed via the web. For example and without limitation, the web-based content may comprise a webpage (e.g., a rendered webpage and/or source HTML of a webpage), as well as any text, image, audio content and/or video content included in a webpage, an RSS feed, or the like. Web-based content collector **302** may be configured to retrieve the aforementioned web-based content from a single webpage or from across a plurality of webpages.

(49) Web based content collector **302** may include a headless web browser. Web based content collector **302** may utilize the headless web browser to navigate to a webpage and capture a screenshot of the webpage without having to render the webpage to a screen.

(50) Web based content collector **302** may also comprise a headful (or GUI-based) web browser. Web based content collector **302** may utilize the headful web browser to navigate to a webpage and render the webpage to a browser window that is displayed on a screen. Web based content collector **302** may then capture a screenshot of the webpage when rendered to the screen. If the webpage extends beyond the boundaries of the browser window, web based content collector **302** may automatically scroll down the webpage and take multiple screenshots to capture the entirety of the webpage.

(51) In a scenario in which the web-based content comprises an image, web based content collector **302** may create a copy of the image by obtaining a copy of the contents of an associated image file without rendering the image, if such image file is available. Alternatively, web based content collector **302** may cause the image to be rendered and then create the copy of the image by capturing a screenshot of the rendered image.

(52) In a scenario in which the web-based content comprises audio content, web based content collector **302** may create a copy of the audio content by obtaining a copy of the contents of an associated audio file without playing back the audio content, if such audio file is available. Alternatively, web based content collector **302** may create a copy of the audio content by playing back the audio content and recording the audio output during playback.

(53) In a scenario in which the web-based content comprises video content, web based content collector **302** may create a copy of the video content by obtaining a copy of the contents of an associated video file without playing back the video, if such a video file is available. Alternatively, web based content collector **302** may create a copy of the video content by playing back the video content and recording the video output during playback.

(54) Web-based content may also include, for example, Portable Document Format (PDF) file content that is accessed via the web. Such PDF file content may include PDF content rendered to a browser window (e.g., using a suitable browser plugin) or raw PDF content. Web-based content

collector **302** may generate a copy of PDF file content by taking a screenshot of such PDF content when rendered by a browser or by obtaining a copy of the raw PDF content.

(55) Web-based content may also include, for example, markup language content (e.g., XML file content) that is accessed via the web (e.g., an RSS feed). Such markup language content may include markup language content rendered to a browser window (e.g., using a suitable browser plugin) or raw markup language content. Web-based content collector **302** may generate a copy of markup language content by listing out of such markup language content when rendered by a browser or by obtaining a copy of the raw markup language content.

(56) Web-based content collector **302** may itself comprise an application that is configured to generate web-based content. For example and without limitation, web-based content collector **302** may comprise a business intelligence application that is configured to generate one or more reports or graphs that are accessible via the web. In accordance with such an implementation, the application may be configured to automatically capture a copy of the reports or graphs and provide them to web-based content transformer **304**.

(57) Web-based content collector **302** may access the web-based content by placing an application programming interface (API) call to a service that returns web-based content responsive to the API call. For example, web-based content collector **302** may place an API call to a social networking service and, responsive to the API call, the social networking service may provide the web-based content (e.g., user-shared text messages, images and/or videos) to web-based content collector **302**. As another example, web-based content collector **302** may place an API call to an artificial intelligence (AI) service and, responsive to the API call, the AI service may provide the web-based content (e.g., AI-generated stories, computer code, query or question responses, language translations, text summaries, or images) to web-based content collector **302**.

(58) Web-based content transformer **304** may be configured to receive the copy of the web-based content captured by web-based content collector **302** and transform the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to a display (e.g., display device **108**) by web-based content presentation application **210** installed on media device **106**.

(59) For example, in a scenario in which the copy of the web-based content comprises a screenshot of a webpage, web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by partitioning the screenshot of the webpage into multiple images, each of which can be independently presented to the display. This approach may be desirable if the webpage is too large to fit within the display window or if the webpage can only be fit within the display window using a pixel resolution that renders image or video content difficult to see and/or text content difficult to read.

(60) In further accordance with this example, web-based content transformer **304** may also automatically annotate one or more images of the aforementioned multiple images. The annotations added to an image may comprise, for example and without limitation, text annotations that are descriptive, evaluative or informative in nature with respect to the content included in each image. Web-based content transformer **304** may associate predefined annotations to each image. Alternatively, web-based content transformer **304** may utilize a machine learning (ML) model or other suitable algorithm to recognize image content and associate annotations therewith based on the nature of the image content.

(61) In another example in which the copy of the web-based content comprises a screenshot of a web page, web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by identifying portions of the webpage that are relevant to one or more users of web-based content presentation application **210**, and then capturing an image of each of the identified portions of the webpage. In this way, only those portions of the webpage deemed relevant to the user(s) may be presented thereto by application **210**. Web-based content transformer **304** may identify the portions of the webpage that are relevant to the user(s), for example, based on a user profile or other information associated with the user(s).

Web-based content transformer **304** may alternatively identify the portions of the webpage that are relevant to the user(s) using a machine learning (ML) model that has been trained to predict content of interest to the user(s), or by using any other suitable algorithm.

(62) In a scenario in which the copy of the web-based content comprises a copy of an image, web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by changing a size, resolution, brightness, contrast, color, and/or any other aspect of the copy of the image.

(63) In a scenario in which the copy of the web-based content comprises a copy of audio content, web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by changing an audio format, encoding type, compression rate, amplitude resolution, sampling rate, and/or any other aspect of the copy of the audio content.

(64) In a scenario in which the copy of the web-based content comprises a copy of video content, web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by changing a resolution, aspect ratio, video format, encoding type, frame rate, bit rate, color space, and/or any other aspect of the copy of the audio content.

(65) Web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by (i) identifying one or more portions of the content in the copy of the web-based content to exclude from presentation to the display and then (ii) generating the transformed copy of the web-based content by removing the identified one or more portions of content from the copy of the web-based content. Such an approach may be used, for example, to selectively remove ads, pop-ups, or other undesired content from the copy of the web-based content. Such an approach may also be used, for example, to selectively remove copyright-protected material from the copy of the web-based content.

(66) Web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by adding content thereto. For example, web-based content transformer **304** may add a title, background image, video, advertisements or the like to the copy of the web-based content.

(67) Web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by (i) identifying one or more portions of content in the copy of the web-based content to present to the display and then (ii) generating the transformed copy of the web-based content from the identified one or more portions of content. Such an approach may be used, for example, to extract content of interest from among a broader set of web-based content collected by web-based content collector **302** and to condense or aggregate that web-based content into a more compact form for presentation to the display.

(68) Web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by transforming the copy of the web-based content into multiple different formats each of which is associated with a different display type. This can enable web-based content presentation application **210** to selectively obtain and present the transformed copy of the web-based content having a format that best suits the display (e.g., display device **108**) to which the web-based content will be presented. For example, web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into multiple different formats corresponding, respectively, to multiple different display device types, display models, display sizes, or the like.

(69) Web-based content transformer **304** may transform the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by tagging a GUI control within the copy of the web-based content. This can enable web-based content presentation application **210** to facilitate user interaction with the tagged GUI control, e.g., through the user of remote control **110** associated with media device **106**. For example, web-based content transformer **304** may tag a GUI control within the copy of the web-based content as a button and application **210** may accordingly enable a user to activate the GUI control by highlighting the GUI control, e.g., by using a directional pad or

touch pad of remote control **110**, and then pressing an “OK” button or other button on remote control **110**. Application **210** may then perform some action based on the user interaction with the button.

(70) Transformed web-based content provider **306** may be configured to store transformed copy of web-based content **136** generated by web-based content transformer **304** to data storage system **134** that is accessible to web-based content presentation application **210** installed on media device **106**. Data storage system **134** may further be accessible to additional instances of web-based content presentation application **210** respectively installed on additional media devices (e.g., smart TV devices), wherein each instance of web-based content presentation application **210** is configured to obtain transformed copy of web-based content **136** from data storage system **134** and present it to a corresponding display.

(71) FIG. **4** illustrates a block diagram of an example implementation of web-based content presentation application **210**, according to some embodiments. As previously described, web-based content presentation **210** may be installed and executed on media device **106**, as well as on any number of additional media devices. As shown in FIG. **4**, web-based content presentation application **210** may comprise a transformed web-based content obtainer **402** and a transformed web-based content presenter **404**. Each of these components may be implemented by processing logic that can comprise hardware (e.g., circuitry, dedicated logic, programmable logic, microcode, etc.), software (e.g., instructions executing on a processing device), or a combination thereof. Each of these components will now be described.

(72) Transformed web-based content obtainer **402** may be configured to obtain transformed copy of web-based content **136** from data storage system **134**. In a scenario in which web-based content transformer **304** transforms the copy of the web-based content into multiple different formats each of which is associated with a different display type, transformed web-based content obtainer **402** may selectively obtain the transformed copy of the web-based content having a format that best suits the display (e.g., display device **108**) to which the web-based content will be presented. For example, transformed web-based content obtainer **402** may obtain a transformed copy of the web-based content having a format that is associated with a display type of display device **108**.

(73) In certain implementations, after obtaining transformed copy of web-based content **136** from data storage system **134**, transformed web-based content obtainer **402** may store transformed copy of web-based content **136** to a cache within media device **106**. Thereafter, when application **210** is required to access transformed copy of web-based content **136**, it may access it from the cache, thus avoiding having to obtain transformed copy of web-based content **136** from the remote data storage system **134**. In further accordance with such an implementation, application **210** may purge transformed copy of web-based content **136** from the cache for a variety of reasons. For example, application **210** may purge transformed copy of web-based content **136** from the cache after expiration of a particular time period, to accommodate other cached content, or in response to receiving a notification from web-based content collection and transformation service **130** or data storage system **134** that an updated version of transformed copy of web-based content **136** is available. Once transformed copy of web-based content **136** is purged from the cache, transformed web-based content obtainer **402** will again need to obtain transformed copy of web-based content **136** from data storage system **134**.

(74) Transformed web-based content presenter **404** may be configured to present transformed copy of web-based content **136** to a display (e.g., display device **108**). In particular, transformed web-based content presenter **404** may be configured to present images, video content and/or audio content that comprise transformed copy of web-based content **136** to the display.

(75) For example, in a scenario in which transformed copy of web-based content **136** comprises multiple images generated through partitioning of a screenshot of a webpage, transformed web-based content presenter **404** may sequentially present each image of the multiple images to the display. In further accordance with such an implementation, transformed web-based content

presenter **404** may enable a user to fast forward, rewind or pause the sequential presentation of each image of the multiple images. For example, transformed web-based content presenter **404** may enable user **132** to use remote control **110** to fast forward, rewind or pause the sequential presentation of each image of the multiple images.

(76) Transformed web-based content presenter **404** may be configured to enable a user to control the presentation of transformed copy of web-based content **136** to the display using only a remote control device. For example, transformed web-based content presenter **404** may be configured to enable user **132** to control the presentation of transformed copy of web-based content to display device **108** using remote control **110**.

(77) In scenarios in which the web-based content collected by web-based content collection and transformation service **130** is updated over time, web-based content collection and transformation service **130** may be configured to periodically or intermittently access the updated web-based content, create a copy of the updated web-based content, transform the copy of the updated web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to a display by application **210**, and store the transformed copy of the updated web-based content to data storage system **134**, where it may be accessed by application **210**. This beneficially enables application **210** to present updated versions of the web-based content to display device **108**. Web-based content collection and transformation service **130** may perform the foregoing operations in response to determining that the web-based content has been updated. Web-based content collection and transformation service **130** may determine that the web-based content has been updated, for example, by monitoring the web-based content or by receiving a notification that the web-based content has been updated.

(78) The foregoing system for presenting web-based content by a smart TV device application may include various security features for to ensure that only certain parties are able to access the web-based content. For example, application distribution service **128** may only allow certain authenticated and/or authorized users or devices to download and install web-based content presentation application **210**. Furthermore, application **210** itself may implement user authentication and/or authorization features to restrict which users or devices may execute the features of the application. Still further, data storage system **134** may store transformed copy of web-based content **136** in a secure manner. For example, data storage system **134** may only allow certain instances of application **210** or smart TV devices to access transformed copy of web-based content **136**. As another example, data storage system **134** may store and provide transformed copy of web-based content **136** in an encrypted state and only trusted version of application **210** may be provided with a decryption key for decrypting the same.

(79) The foregoing system for presenting web-based content by a smart TV device application may be used in a variety of ways. For example, the foregoing system may be used to display web-based reports and graphs (e.g., reports and graphs generated by a web-based business intelligence platform) that are relevant to employees of an enterprise to any number of large screen TVs distributed across one or more offices, thereby enabling the employees to easily view such web-based content. Likewise, in a retail store or restaurant, the foregoing system may be used to display web-based content (e.g., an online menu) to customers or patrons via a number of large screen TVs distributed throughout a shopping or dining space. Other example uses of the system may include, but are not limited to: a system that automatically browses the web (e.g., news websites) to collect information of interest to one or more users and consolidates that information (e.g., into a digest) on a periodic (e.g., daily or weekly) basis, so that the user(s) may then view the information via their TV(s); or a system that enables users to automatically share their own web-based content (e.g., personal pictures and videos previously uploaded to a social network website) with other users, such as family and friends, so that they can easily view it on their TVs. However, these are merely a few examples and persons skilled in the relevant art(s) will appreciate that the above-described system may be used in a multitude of other ways.

(80) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram for a method **500** for collecting web-based content and transforming

and storing the same so that it may be presented to a display by an application installed on a smart TV device, according to some embodiments. Method **500** can be performed by processing logic that can comprise hardware (e.g., circuitry, dedicated logic, programmable logic, microcode, etc.), software (e.g., instructions executing on a processing device), or a combination thereof. It is to be appreciated that not all steps may be needed to perform the disclosure provided herein. Further, some of the steps may be performed simultaneously, or in a different order than shown in FIG. 5, as will be understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art.

(81) Method **500** shall be described with reference to web-based content collection and transformation service **130** of FIGS. **1** and **3**, although method **500** is not limited to that embodiment.

(82) In **502**, web-based content collector **302** accesses web-based content via the world wide web (e.g., network **118**).

(83) In **504**, web-based content collector **302** creates a copy of the web-based content.

(84) In **506**, web-based content transformer **304** transforms the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to a display (e.g., display device **108**) by an application (e.g., web-based content presentation application **210**) installed on a smart TV device (e.g., media device **106**), thereby generating transformed copy of web-based content **136**.

(85) In **508**, transformed web-based content provider **306** stores transformed copy of web-based content **136** to data storage system **134** that is accessible to the application (e.g., web-based content presentation application **210**) installed on the smart TV device (e.g., media device **106**).

(86) FIG. **6** is a flow diagram for a method **600** performed by an application installed on a smart television device for obtaining a transformed copy of web-based content and presenting the same to a display, according to some embodiments. Method **600** can be performed by processing logic that can comprise hardware (e.g., circuitry, dedicated logic, programmable logic, microcode, etc.), software (e.g., instructions executing on a processing device), or a combination thereof. It is to be appreciated that not all steps may be needed to perform the disclosure provided herein. Further, some of the steps may be performed simultaneously, or in a different order than shown in FIG. **6**, as will be understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art.

(87) Method **600** shall be described with reference to web-based content presentation application **210** of FIGS. **1** and **4**, although method **600** is not limited to those embodiments.

(88) In **602**, transformed web-based content obtainer **402** obtains transformed copy of web-based content **136** from data storage system **134**.

(89) In **602**, transformed web-based content presenter **404** presents transformed copy of web-based content **136** to a display (e.g., display device **108**).

(90) Example Computer System

(91) Various embodiments may be implemented, for example, using one or more well-known computer systems, such as computer system **700** shown in FIG. **7**. For example, one or more of media device **106**, remote control **110**, content server(s) **120**, system server(s) **126**, application distribution service **128**, web-based content collection and transformation service **130**, or web-based content presentation application **210** may be implemented using combinations or sub-combinations of computer system **700**. Also or alternatively, one or more computer systems **700** may be used, for example, to implement any of the embodiments discussed herein, as well as combinations and sub-combinations thereof.

(92) Computer system **700** may include one or more processors (also called central processing units, or CPUs), such as a processor **704**. Processor **704** may be connected to a communication infrastructure or bus **706**.

(93) Computer system **700** may also include user input/output device(s) **703**, such as monitors, keyboards, pointing devices, etc., which may communicate with communication infrastructure **706** through user input/output interface(s) **702**.

(94) One or more of processors **704** may be a graphics processing unit (GPU). In an embodiment, a

GPU may be a processor that is a specialized electronic circuit designed to process mathematically intensive applications. The GPU may have a parallel structure that is efficient for parallel processing of large blocks of data, such as mathematically intensive data common to computer graphics applications, images, videos, etc.

(95) Computer system **700** may also include a main or primary memory **708**, such as random access memory (RAM). Main memory **708** may include one or more levels of cache. Main memory **708** may have stored therein control logic (i.e., computer software) and/or data.

(96) Computer system **700** may also include one or more secondary storage devices or memory **710**. Secondary memory **710** may include, for example, a hard disk drive **712** and/or a removable storage device or drive **714**. Removable storage drive **714** may be a floppy disk drive, a magnetic tape drive, a compact disk drive, an optical storage device, tape backup device, and/or any other storage device/drive.

(97) Removable storage drive **714** may interact with a removable storage unit **718**. Removable storage unit **718** may include a computer usable or readable storage device having stored thereon computer software (control logic) and/or data. Removable storage unit **718** may be a floppy disk, magnetic tape, compact disk, DVD, optical storage disk, and/or any other computer data storage device. Removable storage drive **714** may read from and/or write to removable storage unit **718**.

(98) Secondary memory **710** may include other means, devices, components, instrumentalities or other approaches for allowing computer programs and/or other instructions and/or data to be accessed by computer system **700**. Such means, devices, components, instrumentalities or other approaches may include, for example, a removable storage unit **722** and an interface **720**. Examples of the removable storage unit **722** and the interface **720** may include a program cartridge and cartridge interface (such as that found in video game devices), a removable memory chip (such as an EPROM or PROM) and associated socket, a memory stick and USB or other port, a memory card and associated memory card slot, and/or any other removable storage unit and associated interface.

(99) Computer system **700** may further include a communication or network interface **724**. Communication interface **724** may enable computer system **700** to communicate and interact with any combination of external devices, external networks, external entities, etc. (individually and collectively referenced by reference number **728**). For example, communication interface **724** may allow computer system **700** to communicate with external or remote devices **728** over communications path **726**, which may be wired and/or wireless (or a combination thereof), and which may include any combination of LANs, WANs, the Internet, etc. Control logic and/or data may be transmitted to and from computer system **700** via communication path **726**.

(100) Computer system **700** may also be any of a personal digital assistant (PDA), desktop workstation, laptop or notebook computer, netbook, tablet, smart phone, smart watch or other wearable, appliance, part of the Internet-of-Things, and/or embedded system, to name a few non-limiting examples, or any combination thereof.

(101) Computer system **700** may be a client or server, accessing or hosting any applications and/or data through any delivery paradigm, including but not limited to remote or distributed cloud computing solutions; local or on-premises software (“on-premise” cloud-based solutions); “as a service” models (e.g., content as a service (CaaS), digital content as a service (DCaaS), software as a service (SaaS), managed software as a service (MSaaS), platform as a service (PaaS), desktop as a service (DaaS), framework as a service (FaaS), backend as a service (BaaS), mobile backend as a service (MBaaS), infrastructure as a service (IaaS), etc.); and/or a hybrid model including any combination of the foregoing examples or other services or delivery paradigms.

(102) Any applicable data structures, file formats, and schemas in computer system **700** may be derived from standards including but not limited to JavaScript Object Notation (JSON), Extensible Markup Language (XML), Yet Another Markup Language (YAML), Extensible Hypertext Markup Language (XHTML), Wireless Markup Language (WML), MessagePack, XML User Interface

Language (XUL), or any other functionally similar representations alone or in combination. Alternatively, proprietary data structures, formats or schemas may be used, either exclusively or in combination with known or open standards.

(103) In some embodiments, a tangible, non-transitory apparatus or article of manufacture comprising a tangible, non-transitory computer useable or readable medium having control logic (software) stored thereon may also be referred to herein as a computer program product or program storage device. This includes, but is not limited to, computer system **700**, main memory **708**, secondary memory **710**, and removable storage units **718** and **722**, as well as tangible articles of manufacture embodying any combination of the foregoing. Such control logic, when executed by one or more data processing devices (such as computer system **700** or processor(s) **704**), may cause such data processing devices to operate as described herein.

(104) Based on the teachings contained in this disclosure, it will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) how to make and use embodiments of this disclosure using data processing devices, computer systems and/or computer architectures other than that shown in FIG. **9**. In particular, embodiments can operate with software, hardware, and/or operating system implementations other than those described herein.

CONCLUSION

(105) It is to be appreciated that the Detailed Description section, and not any other section, is intended to be used to interpret the claims. Other sections can set forth one or more but not all exemplary embodiments as contemplated by the inventor(s), and thus, are not intended to limit this disclosure or the appended claims in any way.

(106) While this disclosure describes exemplary embodiments for exemplary fields and applications, it should be understood that the disclosure is not limited thereto. Other embodiments and modifications thereto are possible, and are within the scope and spirit of this disclosure. For example, and without limiting the generality of this paragraph, embodiments are not limited to the software, hardware, firmware, and/or entities illustrated in the figures and/or described herein. Further, embodiments (whether or not explicitly described herein) have significant utility to fields and applications beyond the examples described herein.

(107) Embodiments have been described herein with the aid of functional building blocks illustrating the implementation of specified functions and relationships thereof. The boundaries of these functional building blocks have been arbitrarily defined herein for the convenience of the description. Alternate boundaries can be defined as long as the specified functions and relationships (or equivalents thereof) are appropriately performed. Also, alternative embodiments can perform functional blocks, steps, operations, methods, etc. using orderings different than those described herein.

(108) References herein to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “an example embodiment,” or similar phrases, indicate that the embodiment described may include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic, but every embodiment may not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a particular feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, it would be within the knowledge of persons skilled in the relevant art(s) to incorporate such feature, structure, or characteristic into other embodiments whether or not explicitly mentioned or described herein. Additionally, some embodiments can be described using the expression “coupled” and “connected” along with their derivatives. These terms are not necessarily intended as synonyms for each other. For example, some embodiments can be described using the terms “connected” and/or “coupled” to indicate that two or more elements are in direct physical or electrical contact with each other. The term “coupled,” however, can also mean that two or more elements are not in direct contact with each other, but yet still co-operate or interact with each other.

(109) The breadth and scope of this disclosure should not be limited by any of the above-described

exemplary embodiments, but should be defined only in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method for presenting web-based content to a display by an application installed on a smart television device, comprising: accessing, by at least one computer processor, the web-based content via a world wide web; creating a copy of the web-based content; transforming the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to the display by the application, wherein the transformed copy of the web-based content comprises multiple images; and storing the transformed copy of the web-based content to a data storage system that is accessible to the application, wherein the application is configured to obtain the transformed copy of the web-based content from the data storage system and present it to the display, wherein the data storage system stores content and metadata.
2. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the smart television device comprises: a smart television that includes the display; or a media device that is separate from but communicatively connected to the display.
3. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the web-based content comprises a webpage and wherein creating the copy of the web-based content comprises: capturing a screenshot of the webpage.
4. The computer-implemented method of claim 3, wherein transforming the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by the application comprises: partitioning the screenshot of the webpage into the multiple images.
5. The computer-implemented method of claim 4, wherein the application is further configured to sequentially present each image of the multiple images to the display.
6. The computer-implemented method of claim 5, further comprising: annotating one or more images of the multiple images.
7. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein storing the transformed copy of the web-based content to the data storage system comprises: storing the transformed copy of the web-based content to the data storage system that is accessible to multiple instances of the application respectively installed on multiple smart television devices, wherein each instance of the application in the multiple instances of the application is configured to obtain the transformed copy of the web-based content from the data storage system and present it to a corresponding display.
8. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the web-based content is updated over time, and wherein the accessing, creating, transforming and storing are performed periodically or intermittently to enable updated versions of the web-based content to be presented by the application.
9. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein transforming the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by the application comprises transforming the copy of the web-based content into multiple different formats each of which is associated with a different display type; and wherein the application is configured to obtain a transformed copy of the web-based content having a format that is associated with a display type of the display.
10. A system for presenting web-based content to a display by an application installed on a smart television device, comprising: one or more memories; and at least one processor each coupled to at least one of the memories and configured to perform operations comprising: accessing the web-based content via a world wide web; creating a copy of the web-based content; transforming the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to the display by the application, wherein the transformed copy of the web-based content comprises multiple images; and storing the transformed copy of the web-based content to a data storage system that is

accessible to the application, wherein the application is configured to obtain the transformed copy of the web-based content from the data storage system and present it to the display, wherein the data storage system stores content and metadata.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the smart television device comprises: a smart television that includes the display; or a media device that is separate from but communicatively connected to the display.

12. The system of claim 10, wherein the web-based content comprises a webpage and wherein creating the copy of the web-based content comprises: capturing a screenshot of the webpage.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein transforming the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by the application comprises: partitioning the screenshot of the webpage into the multiple images.

14. The system of claim 13, wherein the application is further configured to sequentially present each image of the multiple images to the display.

15. The system of claim 13, wherein the operations further comprise: annotating one or more images of the multiple images.

16. The system of claim 10, wherein storing the transformed copy of the web-based content to the data storage system comprises: storing the transformed copy of the web-based content to the data storage system that is accessible to multiple instances of the application respectively installed on multiple smart television devices, wherein each instance of the application in the multiple instances of the application is configured to obtain the transformed copy of the web-based content from the data storage system and present it to a corresponding display.

17. The system of claim 10, wherein the web-based content is updated over time, and wherein the at least one processor is configured to periodically or intermittently perform the accessing, creating, transforming and storing operations to enable updated versions of the web-based content to be presented by the application.

18. The system of claim 10, wherein transforming the copy of the web-based content into the form suitable for presentation to the display by the application comprises transforming the copy of the web-based content into multiple different formats each of which is associated with a different display type; and wherein the application is configured to obtain a transformed copy of the web-based content having a format that is associated with a display type of the display.

19. A non-transitory computer-readable medium having instructions stored thereon that, when executed by at least one computing device, cause the at least one computing device to perform operations for presenting web-based content to a display by an application installed on a smart television device, the operations comprising: accessing the web-based content via a world wide web; creating a copy of the web-based content; transforming the copy of the web-based content into a form suitable for presentation to the display by the application, wherein the transformed copy of the web-based content comprises multiple images; and storing the transformed copy of the web-based content to a data storage system that is accessible to the application, wherein the application is configured to obtain the transformed copy of the web-based content from the data storage system and present it to the display, wherein the data storage system stores content and metadata.

20. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 19, wherein the smart television device comprises: a smart television that includes the display; or a media device that is separate from but communicatively connected to the display.
